



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Grace University
School Website: <https://www.gracetyler.org/>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Grace Community School (Grace Tyler; Tyler, TX 75701) presents as a distinctly Christian, Christ-centered private school community that emphasizes formation of the whole person through a Biblical worldview, character formation, and athletic and arts excellence. Public materials consistently foreground teaching Jesus, God's Word as the foundational framework, and partnership with Christian families. While the materials demonstrate strong religious foundations and a clear formation-oriented purpose, explicit classical elements such as Great Books, the Trivium/Quadrivium, Socratic pedagogy in the upper grades, or a fully articulated living curriculum are not prominently documented on the public site. The school's public signals align with several classical-education ideals (formation, virtue, Christian worldview, a call to study and excellence), but they do not comprehensively demonstrate the full Great Books/Great Conversation, rigorous canonical curriculum, or Socratic pedagogy emphasized by the classical-school rubric.

Overall classification: NOT CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Religious/metaphysical foundations are explicit and strong (theology, teaching Jesus, God's Word as foundation, Christ-centered mission) and recur across multiple public materials. This is a core, positive indicator for Element 1. - The school's stated purpose centers on formation, virtue, and a Christian worldview, with explicit warnings against reducing education to job/workforce preparation. This supports Element 2 as CLASSICAL in spirit, though some classical vocabulary is not formally stated. - Public materials show a Christian liberal-arts posture and some evidence of high academic achievement, but explicit Great Books, canonical readings, Trivium/Quadrivium, or explicit Socratic pedagogy are not clearly documented in the public materials. Element 3 and Element 4 indicators are weaker or not clearly present in the accessible site content. - Faculty and parent/community signals exist (e.g., Head of School leadership, admissions processes referencing faith), but explicit modern classroom portraits of faculty as the "living curriculum" or a formal "parents as co-teachers" program are not clearly documented on the public pages. - Element 6 (Parents & Community) shows meaningful partnership signals (faith-based admissions criteria, family involvement, church connections) but would benefit from more explicit parent-formation programs, book clubs, or open-campus signals as framed in the classical lexicon.

Executive summaries for each category (category-by-category snapshot) are provided in the sections below, including a keyword-based analysis (Positive/Negative keyword indicators drawn from the Six Essential Elements lexicon) and a justification for the rating.

- Executive Summary — Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Executive Summary — Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Executive Summary — Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL
- Executive Summary — Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL
- Executive Summary — Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL
- Executive Summary — Element 6: School Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle: For a move toward CLASSICAL in more categories, the school could publicly articulate and operationalize explicit classical elements (e.g., Great Books readings; Trivium/Quadrivium

alignment; Socratic seminars in upper grades; a formal “living curriculum” portrait of faculty; explicit parent formation programs and a documented open-campus/parent-involvement framework).

Note: All evidence below is drawn from Grace Community School public materials in the school-specific crawl vector store and the classical lexicon in the knowledge vector store. See citations to the sources cited.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials emphasize that Grace exists to Teach Jesus and place God’s Word as the foundation of all activities (Glimpse of Grace statements).
 - The tag line and mission emphasize Christ-centered education and a Christian worldview across school communications. Example: “Grace exists to Teach Jesus” and “Christ-centered in focus and approach.”
 - Admissions materials cite faith-affirming criteria, including belief in Christ and presence of church involvement and a Christ-centered environment.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (from the lexicon): theology, Christ-centered, God’s Word, faith, Christian worldview, sacred foundation, worship, etc.
 - Negative keywords: none clearly indicated in the public materials. The lexicon’s negative signals (relativism, secular humanism, etc.) do not appear as signals in Grace Tyler’s public materials.
- Why this rating
 - The school’s public communications foreground transcendental moral realism in a Christian framework (truth/ God’s Word as the foundation; Teaching Jesus; Christian worldview). This aligns strongly with the Positive indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, supporting CLASSICAL in this category.
- Citations
 - GCS existence to Teach Jesus; God’s Word as foundation: Graced content excerpt (Glimpse of Grace).
 - Christ-centered emphasis and “Teaching Jesus” tagline: Grace public communications (public pages, including Grace Tyler materials).
 - Admissions criteria anchored in Faith and church involvement: Admissions criteria content.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials emphasize formation over mere information: emphasis on serving Christ and forming the whole person rather than just college admissions or job placement. Example language: “not to get into a good college, not just to get a job, but to serve Him ... eternity” and “education in a Christian worldview across disciplines.”
 - Statements about education aimed at moral and spiritual formation, virtue, and human purpose (telos) through a Christian lens (though not always using the classical vocabulary).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (e.g., formation, virtue, telos, true/good/beautiful, Christian worldview, formation of the whole person).
 - Negative keywords: explicit “workforce preparation” language is not present in Grace’s public materials; the absence of a workforce-prep emphasis aligns with Positive signals in this category. Still, the lexicon’s explicit terms like “formation,” “virtue,” and “telos” are partially echoed in Grace’s framing.

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- Frequency estimate: several positive signals present; few if any explicit negative signals in public messaging.
 - Why this rating
 - The school's stated aim clearly centers on formation and virtue within a theologically grounded teleology. While classical vocabulary like “paideia” or “Great Conversation” is not publicly asserted, the formation-oriented motive aligns with CLASSICAL in intention and effects (virtue, wisdom, human flourishing within a Christian frame).
 - Citations
 - Mission and formation language (Glimpse of Grace, Teaching Jesus; Christian worldview):
 - Not merely job/college focus language (Why Grace content):
 - Admissions emphasis on Christ-centered education and faith-life partnership:

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials emphasize a Christian worldview across disciplines (math, science, art, government, literature) rather than explicit canonical Great Books or the classical Trivium/Quadrivium frameworks. The site does not prominently advertise Great Books, Great Conversation, Latin/Greek, or a canon-driven curriculum. See Grace communications describing broad disciplines and Christian worldview rather than a Great Books cadence.
 - Public materials emphasize high academic achievement and well-rounded education (e.g., National Blue Ribbon recognition, Henderson Cup, etc.), which signals excellence but not canonical classic curriculum structure.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: “history across disciplines” is not explicitly stated; “Great Books” is not shown; “classics” in the sense of traditional canon is not explicit in the site copy.
 - Negative keywords from the lexicon: absence of explicit “Great Books,” “Trivium/Quadrivium,” “Socratic texts,” “primary sources” content in public Grace pages.
 - Frequency: few explicit classical curriculum keywords appear; many generic curriculum verbs (e.g., “math, science, literature”) replace canonical classics language.
- Why this rating
 - While Grace demonstrates robust academic achievement and a broad discipline approach, it lacks explicit evidence of classical curriculum components (Great Books, Great Conversation, Trivium/Quadrivium, Latin/Greek, canonical readings) in public materials. This pushes Element 3 toward NOT CLASSICAL.
- Citations
 - Broad disciplines across math, science, literature, etc., with Christian worldview emphasis:
 - National Blue Ribbon and Henderson Cup context signaling excellence, not canonical classical curriculum:

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials describe strong teacher leadership, student achievement, and sports/arts; however, explicit Pedagogy signals like Socratic seminars, cyclical memory work, chant, dictation, or the “scholé” contemplative/restful learning are not clearly documented on the public pages. The classical lexicon highlights that upper-grade Socratic seminars and rhetoric training are key features; in Grace's public messaging, those pedagogical specifics are not clearly articulated. See reflections on “Glimpse of Grace” and admissions content; no explicit Socratic pedagogy is described in the public site text.
 - Grace's materials emphasize formation, worldview, and discipline, with evidence of athletic and fine-arts excellence; pedagogy specifics are not spelled out as canonical (e.g., memory work, recitation, or classical instrumented pedagogy).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

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- Positive keywords in the Grace site for pedagogy: none clearly align with classical pedagogy keywords (e.g., Socratic seminar, memorization routines, chant, or scholé days). The lexicon's pedagogy terms (Socratic seminars, recitation, chanting, restful learning, etc.) are not visibly present in the public materials.
 - Negative keywords: no explicit “experiential learning only” or “project-based learning dominance” is publicly stated, but the absence of classical pedagogy indicators is noticeable.
 - Why this rating
 - The lack of explicit classical pedagogy signals in public messaging results in a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy. The school's methods may be classical in practice, but the public-facing materials do not clearly demonstrate the standard classical pedagogy markers.
 - Citations
 - Observed pedagogy signals (or lack thereof) in public materials: Glimpse of Grace; admissions pages.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials emphasize leadership (Head of School, Jay Ferguson) and personal bios, but there is limited explicit articulation of a “living curriculum,” teacher portraits, or a “faculty as the core” identity in the public content. The lexicon's criteria describe a faculty that models virtue and is part of a living curriculum, but Grace's public pages do not show these phrases explicitly. The “Jay Blogs” and faculty bios exist, but not a formal living-curriculum portrait.
 - There are meaningful teacher leadership and faith signals, but absence of explicit “portrait of a teacher” or “faculty-as-living-curriculum” language points toward NOT CLASSICAL for this category in public messaging.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords visible: “Head of School” leadership; “teaches Jesus”; “faculty” references appear, but not in the classical lexicon's precise framing (portrait of a teacher, living curriculum, etc.).
 - Negative keywords: no explicit negative signals present in public messaging.
- Why this rating
 - While Grace demonstrates strong teacher leadership and a faith-driven approach, the public materials do not articulate the classical faculty signals (living curriculum, portrait of the teacher) as defined by the Six Essential Elements lexicon.
- Citations
 - Public-facing leadership bios and “Glimpse of Grace” statements:
 - Admissions and public materials referencing faith-based faculty leadership:

Element 6: School Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Grace emphasizes partnership with families and a Christ-centered educational environment; admissions materials describe family involvement and a home-school partnership. The “Admissions Criteria” include faith, church involvement, and partnership with Grace in forming the student. This aligns with the lexicon's directive of partnering with families and parent formation in a classical model.
 - There are signals of parent involvement (Grace Early Education, family engagement, and communications with families), but explicit “parent formation” programs (book studies, classical parent training, or open campus family participation) are not fully documented in the public pages. Still, there are clear signals of parental partnership and church involvement that align with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: “partnership with families,” “co-teachers,” “parential primacy” language is strongly represented in the lexicon and is echoed in Grace's admissions materials. Pub-

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- lic pages indicate faith-life integration with family and local church involvement.
 - Negative keywords: none apparent from public materials in this category; however, explicit parent-formation programming (as a structured, ongoing element) is not clearly documented.
 - Why this rating
 - The school demonstrates meaningful parental partnership and family involvement, which aligns with classical indicators for the Parents & Community category, but the absence of explicit parent-formation programs and classical parent training signals means the category is not fully CLASSICAL.
 - Citations
 - Admissions criteria emphasizing family partnership and faith:
 - Public materials tying Grace to parents and community involvement (Bevin Tang and other student perspectives reflecting family and community engagement): multiple Grace Tyler public pages (e.g., Why Grace; student testimonials).
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What Would Move the Needle

- Element 3 (Curriculum): Publicly articulate and implement canonical classical elements, including explicit Great Books readings, Trivium/Quadrivium alignment, and canonical historical literature. Publish a public curriculum map that shows Great Books usage, Latin/Greek, and primary sources in core disciplines.
 - Element 4 (Pedagogy): Publicly endorse and describe classical pedagogy practices (Socratic seminars in upper grades, structured memory and recitation traditions, scholé days, and ritualized contemplation) and provide concrete examples from classrooms.
 - Element 5 (Faculty): Publish a “portrait of the teacher” and a robust statement about the faculty as the living curriculum, including professional development in classical pedagogy, ongoing faculty formation, and a living-curriculum framework.
 - Element 6 (Parents & Community): Expand explicit parent-formation programming (classical book clubs, home-catechesis guidance, family liturgy alignment) and provide structured open-campus or family-partner events that reinforce parent-as-co-teachers. Increase transparency about family partnerships with public-facing evidence of home-school synergy.
 - If the school actively implements these steps, Element 1 and Element 2 would remain CLASSICAL, Element 6 would move toward CLASSICAL, and Categories 3–5 would move toward CLASSICAL, producing an aggregate shift toward CLASSICAL.
 - The Six Elements lexicon (positive/negative keyword framework) provides a consistent basis for measuring progress toward CLASSICAL status, and Grace’s current public materials show clear alignment with several positive classical indicators (Element 1 and Element 2) but limited explicit canonical classical features across Categories 3–5.
 - Citations for needle-moving concepts (lexicon and canonical terms)
 - Positive/Negative keyword indicators (Six Essential Elements):
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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